SETUP AND TRAINING SOP - ILLUSTRATED

VoiceMeeter Potato for Windows

Sound, sorted - one click at a time.

Every step gets its own page. Every page gets a picture.
Do not rush. Tick the green box before you turn the page.



LOOK: This is VoiceMeeter Potato. Yours will look like this. The names on yours may be a little different - that is normal.

You need: a Windows computer, headphones or speakers, a microphone, and about 20 minutes. Nothing else.

How to use this SOP: One page = one job. Find the red circle in the picture. Click that spot on your computer. Then tick the green CHECK box. **New in this version:** when a step names a button, the picture now IS that button - cut out of the real screen, so it looks exactly like yours. **Part 2 - Know Your Mixer** then explains every button on the Potato screen. Contents: next page.

Official download: vb-audio.com - VoiceMeeter Potato page. Version in this handout: Voicemeeter 3.1.3.0 (ZIP package, 72.2 MB). Potato is donationware from VB-Audio Software.

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What is in this SOP

Part 1 takes you from nothing to a working setup: download, install, pick your headphones and mic, make Potato the boss of Windows sound, then route your apps. **Part 2** explains every part of the Potato window - every button, knob and right-click - with real screenshots. Each Part 2 section has a *what's what* page, a *using it* page, then *in depth* pages.

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BEFORE YOU CLICK ANYTHING

The one idea: a traffic controller for sound

Sound comes **IN** on the left. You press a button to say where it goes **OUT**. That is the whole program.

A

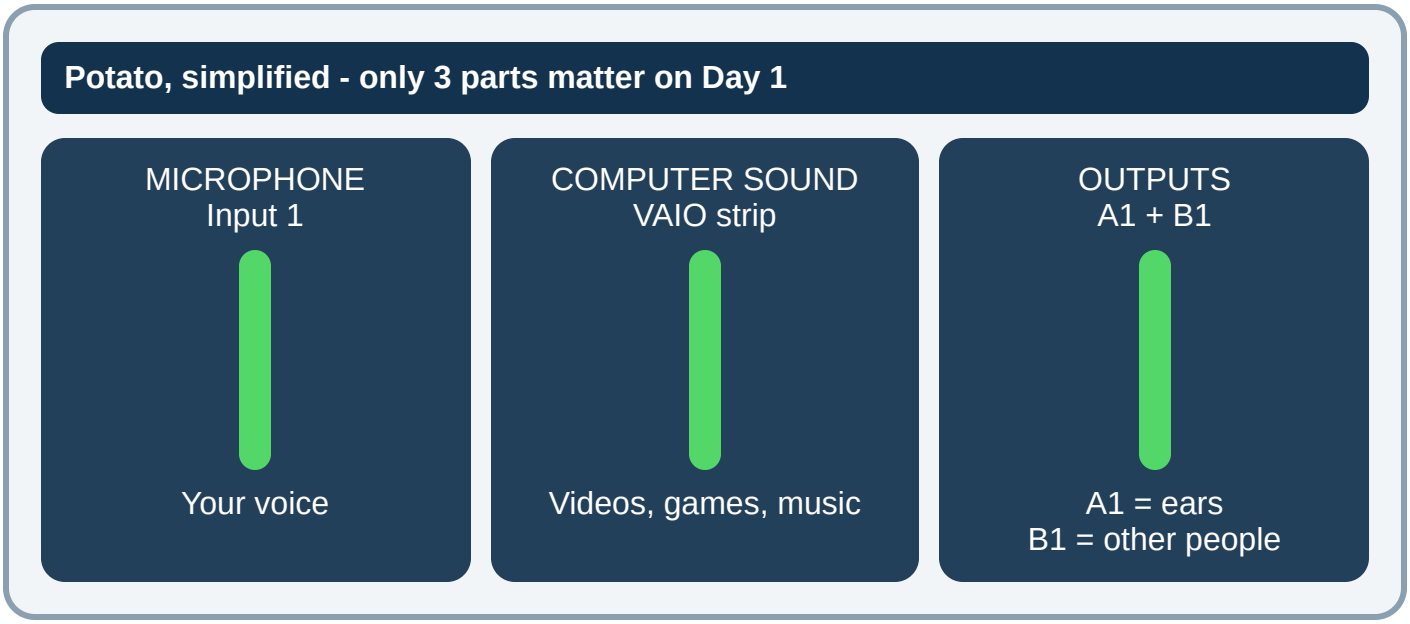
A = Actual ears

Sound for YOU.
Goes to your real headphones or speakers.

B

B = Broadcast

Sound for OTHER PEOPLE.
Discord, Zoom and OBS hear this.



Potato has 5 real inputs, 5 real outputs (A1-A5) and 3 pretend - virtual - ones (B1-B3). **Ignore the rest for now.** Beginners only need **Input 1, A1 and B1**.

CHECK: You can say it out loud - "A is for my ears. B is for other people." Then turn the page.

1

Download it - from the ONLY safe place

Go to **vb-audio.com** and open the **VoiceMeeter Potato** page.

vb-audio.com > VoiceMeeter Potato

1 **Click this ZIP file:**

Voicemeeter8Setup_v3130.zip
Voicemeeter 3.1.3.0 - 72.2 MB

That one file installs Potato. It also installs the smaller Banana and standard versions - you only open Potato.

STOP - never download it from anywhere else. Not FileHippo, not a random "free download" site. Only vb-audio.com.

CHECK: Look in your **Downloads** folder. Is the ZIP file there, about 72 MB? Tick this box and turn the page.

2

Install it - then RESTART

Three clicks to install. Then the most important click of all: Restart.

In your Downloads folder

1. Right-click the ZIP

Extract All

2. In the new folder, right-click the Setup program

Run as administrator

3. ! Click

INSTALL

DO NOT SKIP THE RESTART. When install finishes, restart the whole computer. VB-Audio says: run Setup as administrator and reboot after installation. Without the restart, the new sound devices do not appear - and Steps 5 and 6 cannot work.

CHECK: Your computer has restarted. Now turn the page - we prove it worked in Steps 5 and 6.

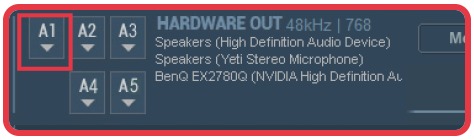
3

Tell Potato where your ears are: A1

Open **VoiceMeeter Potato** from the Start menu. Look at the **top-right corner**.



LOOK: Top-right says HARDWARE OUT. A1, A2, A3 sit above A4 and A5. Click A1.



REAL BUTTONS - cut out of the real Potato screen above. Click **A1**, inside the red box.

Click A1



This is A1, big.

Then pick your **headphones or speakers** from the list that drops down under A1.

If you see two versions of the same name, pick the one that starts with **WDM** - or **ASIO**, if you see it and you use a proper audio interface.

Set A1 FIRST, before anything else. Until A1 is set, you will hear nothing at all. This is the number 1 beginner panic - and now you know why.

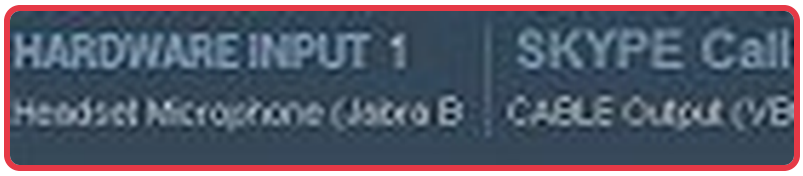
Do this once - so Potato starts by itself: click **Menu** (top-right corner) and turn ON **Run on Windows Startup**. Now Potato is already open after every restart. If Potato is not open, there is no sound at all.

CHECK: The A1 button now shows the name of your headphones or speakers next to it.

4

Tell Potato where your voice is

Now the **top-left corner**. Click **Hardware Input 1** and pick your microphone.



REAL BUTTON AREA - the top of the first strip, cut out of the real screen. Click the name **HARDWARE INPUT 1**.

Pick **your microphone** from the list.

Two versions again?
Pick **WDM**.

Talk test

Green and yellow bars dance when you talk

Your microphone strip is the tall strip on the far left. When you talk, the coloured bars next to it should move up and down - engineers call that "dancing."

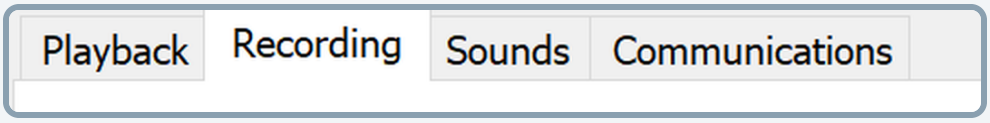
CHECK: Talk in a normal voice. Do the bars dance? Yes - turn the page. No - click Input 1 again and pick a different microphone from the list.

5

Make Potato the boss of ALL Windows sound - Part 1

Press the **Windows key + R** together. Type **mmsys.cpl** and press **Enter**. One old-style Sound box opens.

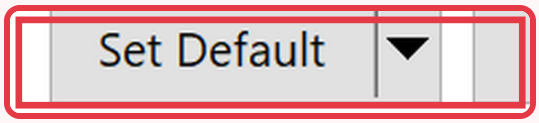
Sound box - Playback part



REAL TABS - cut out of the real Sound box. You are on **Playback** for this part.

Speakers
Realtek - your old default

1 **Voicemeeter Input**
VB-Audio Voicemeeter VAIO



Click this exact button below the list - the real one, cut out of the Sound box.

If a **Set Default Communication Device** choice appears, choose it for this same device too.

Why it looks backwards: Playback "Input" means sound goes **IN to Potato**. Backwards name, correct setting.

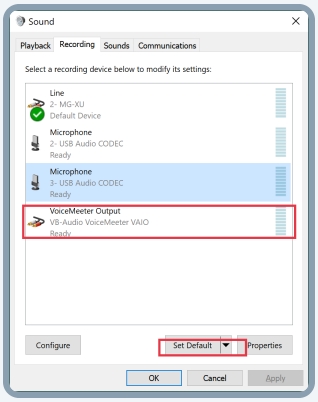
CHECK: A green tick now sits on **Voicemeeter Input (VB-Audio Voicemeeter VAIO)**. Stay in this same box - Part 2 is next.

5

Make Potato the boss - Part 2: Recording

Still in that same Sound box? Click the **Recording** tab at the top.

Sound box - Recording part (a real one)

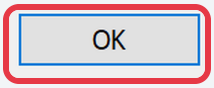


THE REAL SOUND BOX. Click the **VoiceMeeter Output** row (top red box), then **Set Default** (bottom red box). The other names came from the computer that took this picture - yours will be a little different, and that is fine.

Can't see Voicemeeter Output? Look for **Voicemeeter Out B1** - same thing, newer name.

One quick extra job before you close: click the **Communications** tab at the top of this same box and choose **Do nothing**. That stops Windows turning all your sound down in the middle of a Discord or Zoom call.

Now click this real **OK** button to close the box:



Backwards again - and still correct: Recording "Output" means sound comes **OUT of Potato** to your apps, so Discord and Zoom can hear you.

CHECK - the big test: Play any YouTube video. You can **hear it**, and the middle strip in Potato dances. Both? Windows is now Potato's. Turn the page.

6

The golden routing - set these buttons

Back in Potato. Every strip has small **A** and **B** buttons on its right side. Lit = ON. Dark = OFF. Set just these:

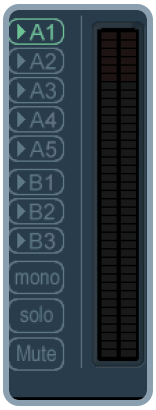
The only 2 strips you touch today - real buttons

YOUR MICROPHONE
Input 1



B1 is GREEN = ON
A1 is grey = OFF

COMPUTER SOUND
VAIO strip



A1 is GREEN = ON
B1 is grey = OFF*

* Turn computer B1 ON only when people on a call should also hear your videos or game. These are the real buttons, cut out of the screen - green means ON, grey means OFF.

Why mic A1 is OFF: A1 is your own ears. Mic to A1 means hearing your own voice back in your headphones. Nobody wants that. Mic to **B1** sends your voice to other people instead.

CHECK: Play a video - you hear it. Talk - the mic bars dance, but your voice is NOT in your headphones. Perfect. You are set up.

Way 1: Everything together

Use this on Day 1. It is what you already did in Step 5 - and for many people, it is enough forever.



Good for	Remember
Beginners, everyday listening, first calls	Windows default stays on Voicemeeter Input / Output - do not change it back

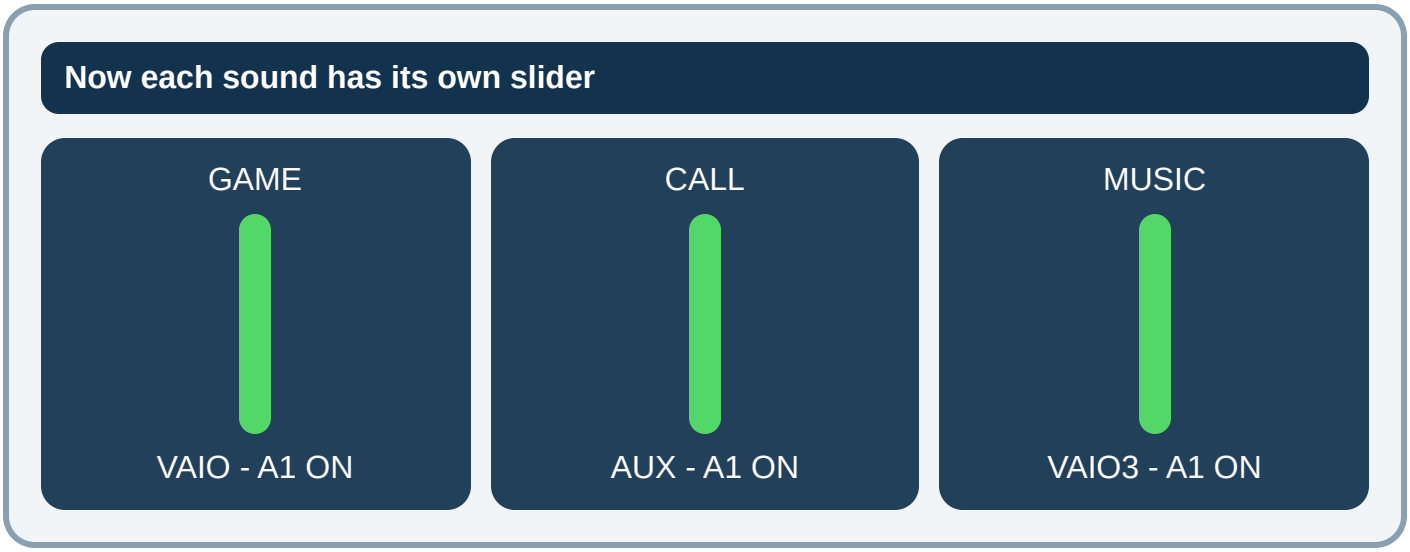
CHECK: Drag the VAIO strip slider in Potato. ALL computer sound gets quieter and louder together. That is Way 1 working.

Way 2: Split your apps in Windows

Use this in Week 2, when you want the game loud and Discord quiet - each on its own slider.

Open **Settings > System > Sound > Volume mixer**. Next to each app, choose where it sends its sound:

App	Send it to	Its strip in Potato
Game	Voicemeeter Input (VAIO)	VAIO strip
Discord / Zoom	Voicemeeter Aux Input	AUX strip
Music / Browser	Voicemeeter VAIO3 Input	VAIO3 strip



CHECK: Play music and a game at the same time. Move ONE strip slider. Only that one sound changes. That is Way 2 working.

Way 3: Set it inside the app itself

Use this for calls and recording. Leave Windows alone. Open the settings *inside* Discord, Zoom or OBS and set these two lines:

Inside Discord / Zoom / OBS - Audio settings

1. **Microphone / Input device**

   Voicemeeter Output (VB-Audio Voicemeeter VAIO)
   This is B1 - your voice, already mixed by Potato

2. **Speaker / Output device**

   Voicemeeter Aux Input (VB-Audio Voicemeeter AUX VAIO)
   Call sound lands on its own AUX strip, separate from your game

This keeps call sound on the AUX strip, so you can turn the call up or down without touching game or music volume.

Can't see Voicemeeter Output? Look for **Voicemeeter Out B1** - same thing, newer name.

CHECK: Join a test call. The other person hears you, you hear them, and their voice moves the AUX strip - not the VAIO strip.

Know Your Mixer: the map

Potato is set up. Now learn what every part of the screen does. We go round the screen in **7 sections**, in the same order every time.



LOOK: the whole Potato window, split into 7 sections. Find each number on your own screen. (Real screenshot, Potato 3.1.3.0 on Windows 10.)

1. **Top bar** - Menu, VBAN, window buttons
2. **Hardware inputs 1-5** - mics and instruments
3. **Virtual inputs** - computer sound: VAIO, AUX, VAIO3
4. **Hardware Out A1-A5** - your headphones and speakers
5. **Cassette recorder** - record and play back
6. **Special FX** - Reverb, Delay, External FX Return
7. **Master section** - all 8 outputs: A1-A5 real, B1-B3 virtual

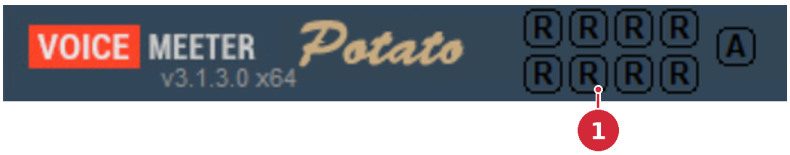
Every section: a *what's what* page (picture with red numbers + table), a *using it* page (real examples, **Try it now**, STOP, CHECK), then *in depth* pages for every knob, menu and right-click. A cheat sheet of mouse tricks ends Part 2.

Pictures in Part 2 are **real screenshots** of a fresh Voicemeeter Potato 3.1.3.0 on Windows 10 (100% display size), enlarged, with red numbers added - nothing picked yet, so yours may show your own device names. Boxes, menus and panels that only open on a click (Menu, A1 list, Recorder Options, Reverb, Delay, EQ windows, right-click menus) are labelled VB-Audio manual figures.

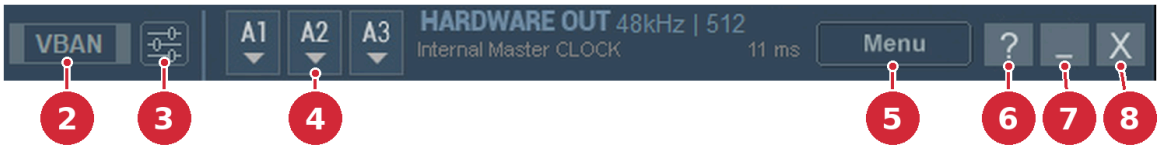
CHECK: Open Potato. Point at all 7 sections on your own screen, in order.

1 The top bar

The strip along the very top. Left end: the Potato name. Right end: VBAN, Menu and the window buttons.



Left end. Your version is under the logo: **v3.1.3.0 x64**. (Real screenshot, Potato 3.1.3.0 on Windows 10.)



Right end. (Real screenshot, Potato 3.1.3.0 on Windows 10.)

#	Control	What it does
1	Small R and A boxes	The manual does not explain these. Leave them alone.
2	**VBAN**	Opens the VBAN settings box. VBAN sends sound to - or gets sound from - other computers on your home or office network.
3	Small icon next to VBAN	**Windows Audio Map** button. Click = map of all sound devices; right-click = Windows sound boxes (Section 1 in depth).
4	A1 A2 A3 (A4 A5 below) + HARDWARE OUT	Where you pick your headphones and speakers. That is Section 4.
5	**Menu**	Potato's main menu: Restart Audio Engine, Load / Save Settings, System Tray, Run on Windows Startup, Lock Graphic User Interface, System Settings and more.
6	**?**	Not explained in the manual.
7	_	Hides the window - the usual Windows minimise button. Potato keeps running.
8	**X**	The usual Windows close button. Closing Potato can stop ALL sound - see the STOP box over the page.

Macro buttons are not on this window: MacroButtons is a separate VB-Audio app, started from the Menu ("Run MacroButtons on Voicemeeter start").

The top bar in real life

Zoom / Teams training

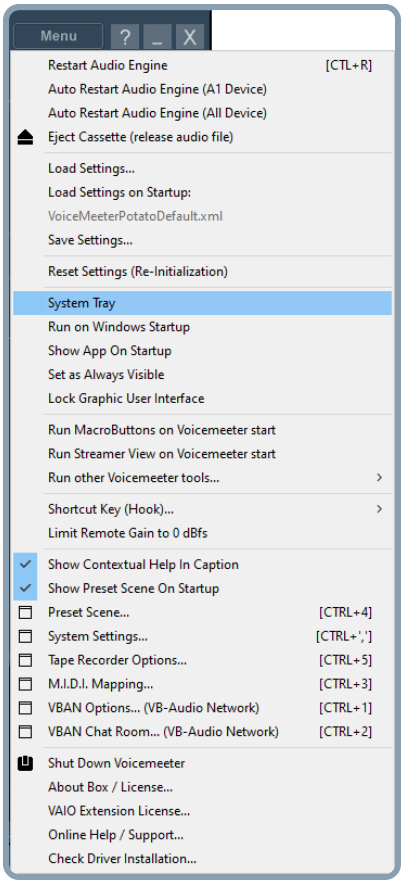
Got the room sounding right? Click **Menu > Save Settings...** and save a file. Next session, **Menu > Load Settings...** brings it all back.

Discord gaming

Plugged in a USB headset and the sound stopped? Click **Menu > Restart Audio Engine**. VB-Audio says this restarts the sound when a device was plugged or unplugged.

OBS stream

Going live? **Menu > Lock Graphic User Interface** stops a stray click changing your settings mid-stream.



The Menu, opened (official manual figure, p.47).

Try it now: Click **Menu**. Find **Restart Audio Engine** and click it - that is the fix you will use most. Open Menu again and check **Run on Windows Startup** has a tick (Step 3).

STOP - do not click X to "tidy up". If Potato is closed while Windows still uses it, there is no sound at all. Click _ instead to hide it.
Never click Reset Settings in the Menu unless your trainer says so - it wipes your whole setup.

CHECK: You can find **Menu**, and **Restart Audio Engine** inside it, without looking at this page.

The Menu, item by item (1 of 2)

Click Menu at the top right. Top half of the menu, in screen order:

Menu item (exact wording, shortcut)	What it does
SOUND ENGINE	
Restart Audio Engine CTRL+R	Restarts Potato's sound. Use it when the sound stops after you plug or unplug a device. **The fix you will use most.**
Auto Restart Audio Engine (A1 Device)	Restarts the sound by itself when the A1 device is unplugged.
Auto Restart Audio Engine (All Device)	Restarts the sound by itself when any device is unplugged.
Eject Cassette (release audio file)	Lets go of the sound file the cassette recorder is using.
YOUR SETTINGS FILE	
Load Settings...	Opens a saved setup file.
Load Settings on Startup: VoiceMeeterPotatoDefault.xml	Loads this settings file every time Potato starts, so it always starts the same. The grey line shows which file.
Save Settings...	Saves your whole setup as a file.
Reset Settings (Re-Initialization)	Wipes Potato's complete setup. **Trainer only.**
WINDOW AND START-UP	
System Tray	Puts Potato in the Windows system tray.
Run on Windows Startup	Potato starts by itself with Windows (Step 3).
Show App On Startup	Shows the Potato window when it starts.
Set as Always Visible	Keeps the window on top of other windows.
Lock Graphic User Interface	Locks the window so nothing can be changed by accident.
HELPER APPS	
Run MacroButtons on Voicemeeter start	Starts the MacroButtons app with Potato.
Run Streamer View on Voicemeeter start	Starts the Streamer View app with Potato.
Run other Voicemeeter tools... ▸	A submenu to run other apps installed with Potato. The manual names 8x8 Gain Matrix, 15 Bands graphic EQ and VBAN2MIDI. Not needed for a normal setup.

STOP: Never click **Reset Settings** during a call or a stream. The shortcut next to an item (e.g. CTRL+R) is printed in the Menu itself.

The Menu, item by item (2 of 2)

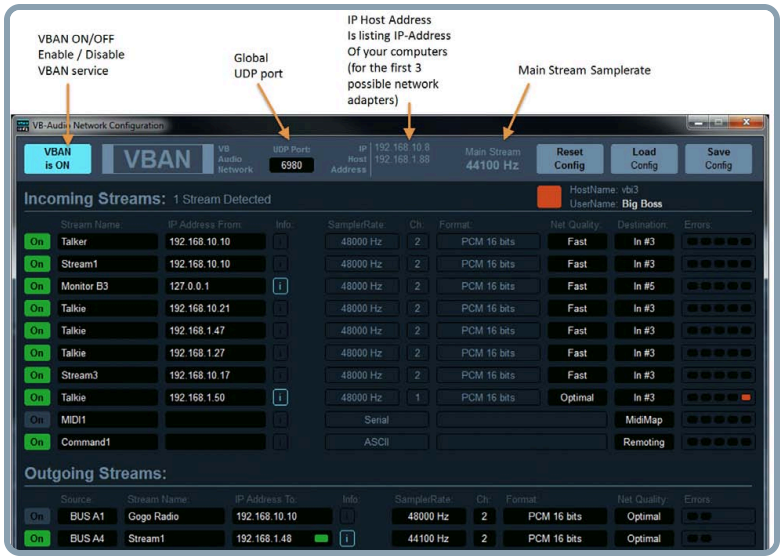
Bottom half of the menu. ▸ = opens a submenu.

Menu item (exact wording, shortcut)	What it does
KEYBOARD, REMOTE, HELP	
Shortcut Key (Hook)... ▸	A submenu to "hook" keyboard keys so they control the volume of A1, A2 or Strip 1. **Which keys it offers is not shown in our screenshot and not listed in the manual.**
Limit Remote Gain to 0 dBFs	A MIDI controller can raise levels only to 0 dB instead of +12 dB.
Show Contextual Help In Caption	Ticked by default: a short help line shows in the top bar when you point at a control.
Show Preset Scene On Startup	Opens the Preset Scene box every time Potato starts.
SETTING BOXES	
Preset Scene... **CTRL+4**	Opens the Preset Scene box: 64 saved setups, kept in Documents > Voicemeeter.
System Settings... **CTRL+,**	Sound device settings (buffer size, preferred sample rate, effects choice). Leave to your trainer.
Tape Recorder Options... **CTRL+5**	Opens Recorder Options - the same box as right-clicking the tape deck (Section 5).
M.I.D.I. Mapping... **CTRL+3**	Connects a MIDI controller (knobs and faders you can touch) to Potato.
VBAN Options... (VB-Audio Network) **CTRL+1**	Opens the VBAN box - the same as the VBAN button.
VBAN Chat Room... **CTRL+2**	Text chat between VBAN computers on your network.
Windows Audio Map... **CTRL+6**	Opens the Windows Audio Map - the same as the Audio Map icon.
Windows Audio Settings... ▸	A submenu. Its items are not shown in our screenshot. (The Audio Map icon's right-click opens the Windows sound boxes.)
CLOSE AND INFORMATION	
Shut Down Voicemeeter	Closes Potato. **All sound through Potato stops.**
About Box / License...	Links to more information and the VB-Audio shop.
VAIO Extension License...	Licence box for extra virtual inputs/outputs (Windows 10 64-bit and newer).
Online Help / Support...	Not explained in the manual.
Check Driver Installation...	Runs VBDeviceCheck: a check of the VB-Audio drivers.

STOP: Never click **Shut Down Voicemeeter** during a call or a stream.

VBAN: sound over your network

VBAN sends sound to - and gets sound from - other computers and phones on the same home or office network. **Click VBAN** to open its settings box.



The VBAN box (official manual figure, p.61). Orange labels are VB-Audio's.

Part	What it does
VBAN is ON / OFF	Turns the whole VBAN service on or off.
UDP Port	The network "door" VBAN uses: 6980 by default. Two apps on one PC cannot share a port.
Incoming Streams	Sound you want to **hear** from another computer. Name + IP address must match the sender. Right-click the name or address to pick a stream that was found. Switch it **On**.
Outgoing Streams	Sound you **send**: pick the source bus (A or B), a stream name and the other computer's IP address. Switch it **On**.
Net Quality	FAST for a good network; slower settings for a busy one.
Error lights	Blink red on problems: too many / broken / out-of-order / missing / too few packets.

Potato can hear 8 streams and send 8. Each: 11025 Hz to 96 kHz, 16 or 24 bit, 1 to 8 channels. Sending to an address ending in .255 reaches every computer on a wired network.

STOP - not needed for a normal setup. Leave VBAN alone unless your trainer sets it up. If Windows asks about the firewall for VBAN, ask your trainer.

The Audio Map button

The small icon just right of VBAN is the **Windows Audio Map** button.



Official manual figure, p.52. The top bar shows the help line "AUDIO MAP: CLICK to open the Windows Audio Map".

Do this	What happens
Click it	Opens the Windows Audio Map: one big picture of every Windows sound device and app around Potato - recording devices on top, Potato's virtual inputs and outputs around it, playback devices at the bottom. Arrows show where sound goes.
Right-click it	A menu of Windows sound boxes: **Windows Sound Settings**, **Apps Volume and Device Preferences**, **Privacy for Microphone**, **Sounds Playback Devices**, **Sounds Recording Devices**.
Inside the map	Drag to move around. Mouse wheel (or + and - keys) to zoom. Right-click for **Refresh** - some settings only update after a refresh.

Try it now: Right-click the icon. Click **Windows Sounds Playback Devices** - it is the same Sound box you used in Step 5. Close it with **Cancel**.

CHECK: You can open the Windows Sound box from Potato in two clicks.

2 Hardware inputs 1-5

Five strips on the left - one per mic or instrument. All five work the same: learn one.



Strip 1, "Stereo Input 1". Real screenshot, Potato 3.1.3.0 on Windows 10.

#	Control	What it does
1	Name + device	Shows **Stereo Input 1** / **Select Input Device**. Click to pick your mic.
2	INTELLIPAN	Drag the dot to change the "colour" of your voice.
3	EQ	Right-click: opens a 6-band EQ for this strip.
4	Comp	Compressor: evens out loud and quiet - and boosts the voice.
5	Gate	Closes (silences) when sound drops below a level.
6	Denoiser	Removes background noise, 0 to 10. Adds a little delay when not 0.
7	Reverb send	How much of this strip goes into the Reverb (Section 6).
8	Delay send	Into the Delay. Says **C5** instead if C5 was swapped in for the Delay.
9	Post	Lit = the send follows the fader.
10	External FX 1 / 2	Only works with an ASIO device on A1. Leave at 0.
11	Meter	How loud the sound coming in is. Click in it to set a limit.
12	Fader Gain	Volume of this strip.
13	A1-A5	Send to real outputs - your ears. Lit = ON.
14	B1-B3	Send to virtual outputs - what Discord, Zoom, OBS hear.
15	mono	Makes this strip mono (the manual gives no more detail).
16	solo	Listen to only this strip (or a few).
17	Mute	Silences this strip.

Hardware inputs in real life

Zoom / Teams training call

Mic on Input 1: **B1 ON, A1 OFF** (Step 6). Computer fan humming? Turn **Denoiser (6)** up a little at a time until the hum goes.

Podcast recording

Host mic on Input 1, guest mic on Input 2, both **B1 ON**. Turn **Comp (4)** up a little so voices stay steady. Comp boosts the voice, so pull the **fader (12)** down to match.

Discord gaming

Stepping away? Click **Mute (17)** on your mic strip. Want to hear only your mic for a test? Click **solo (16)**, then click it again to finish.

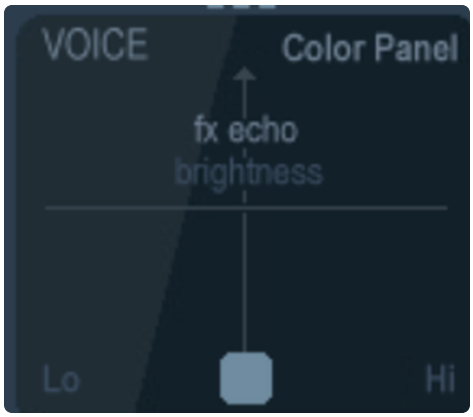
Try it now: Talk - watch the **meter (11)** move. Turn **Denoiser (6)** to 5, then back to 0. Click **Mute (17)**: it lights up. Click it again to turn it off.

STOP - hearing your own voice in your headphones? Mic **A1** is ON. Turn it OFF; keep **B1** ON.
A strange panel took over the strip? You right-clicked a knob. Right-click it again to go back.
Knob moved by accident? Double-click it - it goes back to its default.

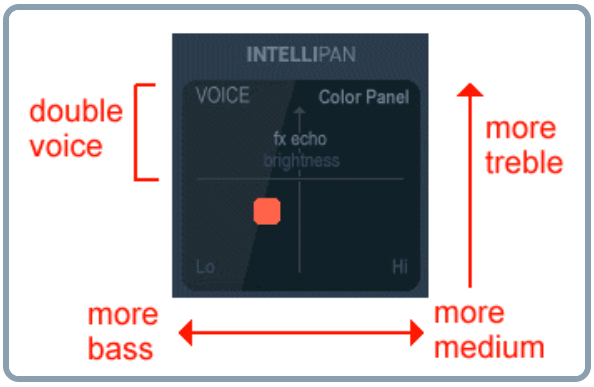
CHECK: Say out loud what **A1**, **B1** and **Mute** do on your mic strip, and point at **Denoiser**.

INTELLIPAN: shape your voice

The dark square at the top of every hardware strip. It has **3 panels**; **right-click the panel** to switch between them.



Real screenshot: the Color Panel, dot in the neutral spot.



Which way does what (official manual figure, p.20).

Panel	What it does
Color Panel (first)	Drag the dot to change the "colour" of the voice: 3 sound bands plus a tiny reverb in the top half. Up = more treble. Left = more bass, right = more medium. Top left = "double voice".
Position 3D	A "binaural" effect: places the voice in a small virtual room, left or right. Stereo only. Helps when several people talk at once.
Modulation	Chorus-type effects. Bottom = chorus / phasing, top = modulation. Left side adds feedback. Further from the middle = stronger.
The 3 small dots under INTELLIPAN	Each turns **orange** when its panel is not neutral: 1st = Color, 2nd = Modulation, 3rd = 3D.

Try it now: Talk while you drag the Color Panel dot up - your voice gets brighter. **Double-click** the dot: it jumps back to neutral. (Double-click resets any control.)

STOP - for calls and training keep the dot neutral. All 3 dots dark = nothing changed.

INTELLIPAN EQ Strip EQ and Strip Menu

The small EQ button

Right-click EQ (right of the word INTELLIPAN) to open a **6-band parametric EQ** for this strip - the same EQ as on the output buses, in stereo. Peak gain: -36 dB to +18 dB.



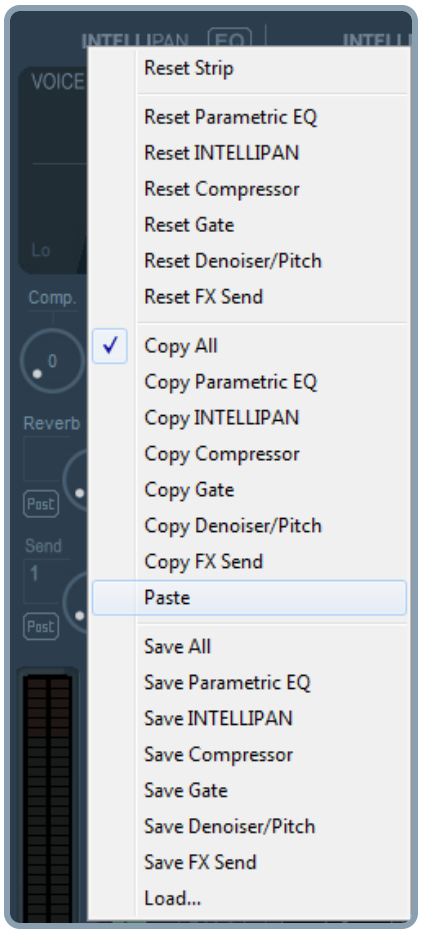
The strip EQ window (official manual figure, p.28).

The Strip Menu

Right-click the word INTELLIPAN. You can:

- **Reset** the whole strip - or one effect - to default.
- **Copy / Paste** settings from one strip to another.
- **Save / Load** them as a file to share.

The fader, solo / Mute and the A / B buttons are NOT touched by the Strip Menu.



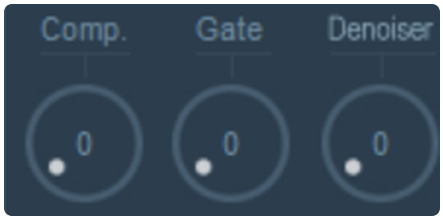
Strip Menu (official manual figure, p.29).

Try it now - copy your mic settings to strip 2, in 3 steps:

1. Right-click **INTELLIPAN** on strip 1
2. Click **Copy All**
3. Right-click INTELLIPAN on strip 2, click **Paste**

STOP - a strip sounds strange and you do not know why? Right-click INTELLIPAN > **Reset Strip**. Ask first if it is someone else's strip.

Comp, Gate and Denoiser in detail



Real screenshot: all three at 0 (off).

Knob	Plain knob	Right-click = detailed view
Comp.	Simple compressor with "auto make-up": evens out loud and quiet AND gives the voice a big boost - so turn the fader down to match.	Input Gain, Ratio, Threshold, Attack, Release, Knee, Output Gain, Auto make Up.
Gate	Simple gate: shuts the sound off when it drops below a level.	Threshold, Damping Max (OFF = closes fully), BP Sidechain (react to one band only), Attack, Hold, Release.
Denoiser	Removes background noise. **0 to 10.** When not 0 it adds a small delay to this strip.	Noise Floor Remover (same as the knob) + **Voice Modeler**: Enable Fx, Dry / Wet, Pitch and Formants (-12 to +12 semitones), 8 presets.

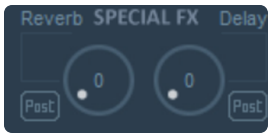
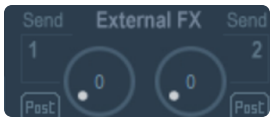
The manual does not give a number range for the Comp. and Gate knobs.

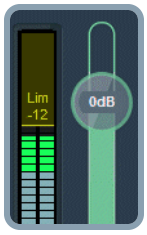
Mouse trick (detailed view)	What it does
Right-click the knob again	Back to the normal strip.
CTRL + right-click a setting	Type an exact value.
SHIFT + click a setting	Opens a precision slider for fine changes.
PRG shows on the knob	Detailed settings were changed. Moving the plain knob again replaces them.
CTRL + right-click the knob	**Undo**: brings your detailed settings back.

The detailed view shows a graph where INTELLIPAN was, level meters, and red meters for how much the sound is being turned down.

Try it now: Right-click **Denoiser**, look, right-click again to go back. Then set Denoiser to 3 and talk with a fan running.

Sends, meter, fader and buttons

Control	What it does - and the tricks
	**Reverb / Delay send:** how much of this strip goes into Potato's Reverb or Delay (Section 6). **Post**  lit = the send follows the fader; off = it ignores the fader.
	**External FX Send 1 / 2:** sends to outside effect units. Works only with an ASIO device on A1 and its channels set in System Settings. Leave at 0.
Meter (left of the fader)	How loud the incoming sound is. **Click in the meter** to set a limit (a "limiter") - **right-click** to type it: -40 to +12 dB. **CTRL + click** swaps the yellow and green limiter (green avoids crackle; adds 5 ms). The limiter works before the fader.
Fader Gain	Volume of this strip. Drag it. **Double-click** it: back to its default.
	**A1-A5 / B1-B3:** send this strip to that output. Lit = ON. **Right-click** them: see every bus's own mix for all strips at once (right-click again to go back).
	**mono** = make this strip mono (no more detail in the manual). **solo** = hear only this strip (or a few). **Mute** = silence this strip.
Strip name	**Right-click the bottom of the fader** to give the strip a name, e.g. "Mic". Needed for the Streamer View app.

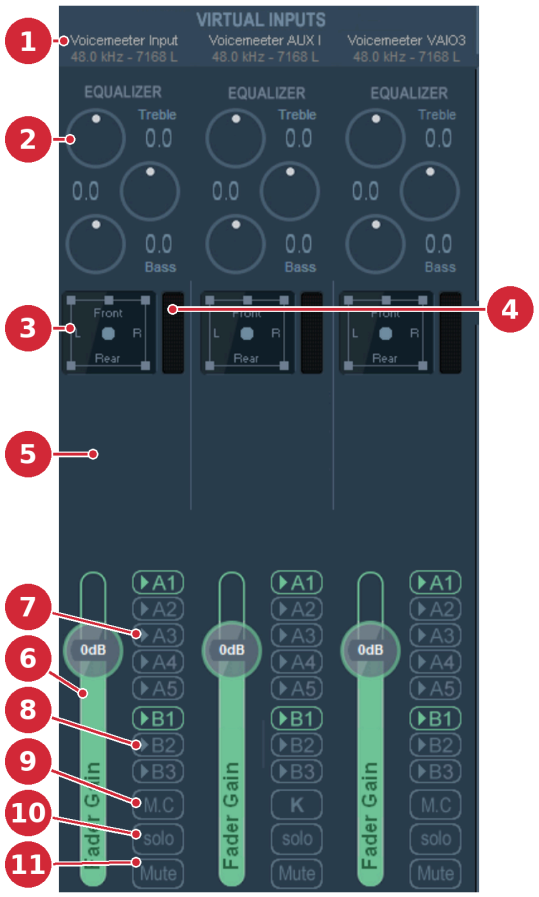


A limit set at -12 dB (official manual figure, p.24).

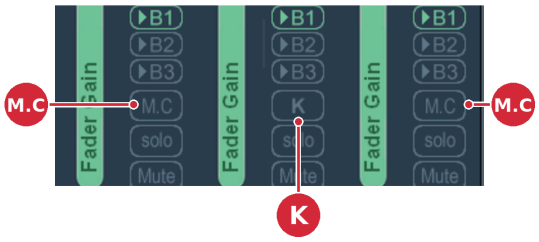
Try it now: Right-click the bottom of your mic fader and name it **Mic**. Then click **A1** with the right mouse button - look - and right-click again to go back.

3 Virtual inputs: computer sound

Three strips in the middle. Sound from Windows and your apps comes in here - no cable needed.



Real screenshot, Potato 3.1.3.0 on Windows 10.



AUX has **K**; the other two have **M.C**. (Real screenshot.)

#	Control	What it does
1	Strip name	**Voicemeeter Input** (VAIO), **Voicemeeter AUX I**nput (AUX), **Voicemeeter VAIO3**. Below it, **48.0 kHz - 7168 L**: the sample rate, and the strip's delay (latency) setting - 7168 is the safe default. Leave it.
2	EQUALIZER	3 knobs: Treble (top), Bass (bottom), medium (middle). Boost or cut.
3	5.1 pan	Drag the dot to place the sound front / back, left / right. Double-click to centre.
4	Meter	How loud this strip is.
5	App list	Empty here - nothing is playing yet. Apps playing into this strip, each with a slider and **M** (mute) - the same as the Windows Volume mixer. Right-click to show more.
6	Fader Gain	Volume of ALL sound on this strip.
7	A1-A5	To real outputs - your ears.
8	B1-B3	To virtual outputs - calls and streams.
9	M.C	"Mute Center": mutes the centre channel - where film dialogue sits - on 5.1 / 7.1 sound.
10	solo	Listen to only this strip.
11	Mute	Silences this strip.
K	K (AUX)	Karaoke: removes the voice from music. 4 modes: K-m, K-1, K-2, Kv.

Virtual inputs in real life

Discord gaming

Game to **VAIO**, Discord to **AUX** (Way 2 or Way 3). Friends too loud? Pull the **AUX fader (6)** down - the game stays the same.

OBS stream

Music player to **VAIO 3**. Turn **A1** ON so you hear it and **B1** ON so the stream hears it. Too loud for viewers? Lower the VAIO 3 fader.

Zoom / Teams training

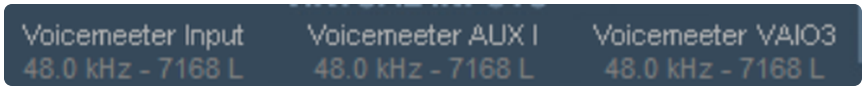
Showing a video to the class? Turn **B1 ON** on the VAIO strip so the call hears the video too. Turn it OFF again afterwards.

Try it now: Play a YouTube video. Find your browser in the **app list (5)**. Move its small slider - then open the Windows Volume mixer: the browser's slider moved there too.

STOP - an app is missing from the list, or a closed app is still there? Click **Menu > Restart Audio Engine** - it refreshes the list.
Discord shows up on every strip? That is Discord opening every device, not your mistake.
Voices vanished from your music? K is ON. Click it OFF.

CHECK: You can say which strip your browser plays into, and turn just that strip down.

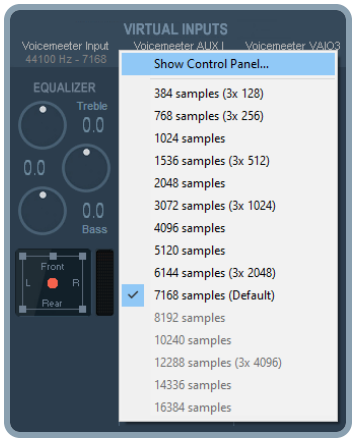
Virtual strips: name, delay setting, EQ



Real screenshot: the three virtual strip names.

Right-click the name: the delay (latency) menu

The **7168** in "48.0 kHz - 7168 L" is this virtual input's delay setting in samples. **7168 samples is expected to work 100%.** Smaller (3072 or less) = less delay, but it may break up. Changing Voicemeeter Input also changes B1 (they are a pair). **Show Control Panel** opens the VAIO Control Panel.



Official manual figure, p.56.



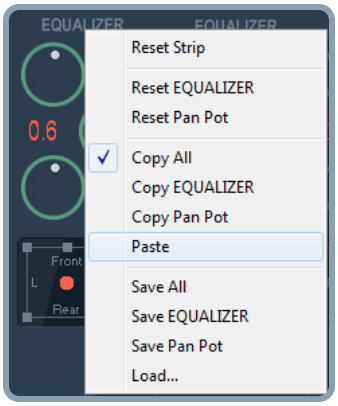
Real screenshot.

EQUALIZER: 3 knobs

Boost or cut **Treble** (top knob), **medium** (middle) and **Bass** (bottom knob). The number shows the setting; 0.0 = unchanged. Double-click a knob to reset it.

Click the word EQUALIZER: Strip Menu

Reset, Copy / Paste and Save / Load this strip's settings - like the hardware Strip Menu (Section 2).



Official manual figure, p.29.

STOP - do not change 7168 unless your trainer asks. If the sound from your apps crackles after someone changed it, set it back to **7168 samples (Default)**.

Virtual strips: 5.1 pan, apps, M.C and K



5.1 pan: drag the dot to send the sound to front left, front centre, front right, rear left or rear right. **Double-click** = back to **Normal** mode, dot in the exact centre.



Official manual figure, p.22.

Right-click the pan box for the pan-mode menu:

Normal	As it is.
MONO	Like the mono button.
Repeat Mono	Left channel copied into the 7 others.
Repeat Stereo	Left + right copied to channels 3+4, 5+6, 7+8.
Mix Down, Up Mix, ... Only	Work like the bus modes (Section 7).

The app list

Shows the first **4 apps** playing into the strip, each with a level meter, a volume slider and **M** (mute) - linked both ways to the Windows Volume Mixer. **Right-click** to show up to 32 apps. Empty on a fresh install (nothing playing yet).



M.C (Mute Center) - on Voicemeeter Input and VAIO3: mutes channel 3, the centre, where film dialogue sits on 5.1 / 7.1 sound.



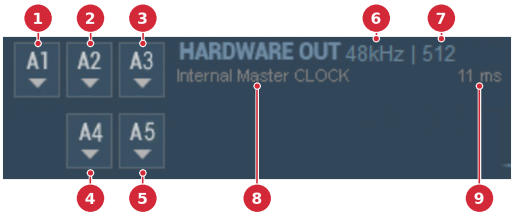
K (Karaoke) - on AUX only: removes the voice from stereo music.

K mode	What it removes
K-m	Everything common to left and right - all mono sound.
K-1	Like K-m but keeps some bass and treble.
K-2	Like K-1, keeps more bass and treble.
Kv	When nothing else works (e.g. a mono track): filters out the voice range, 200-4000 Hz.

The manual does not say how you step through the K modes - click K and watch its label.

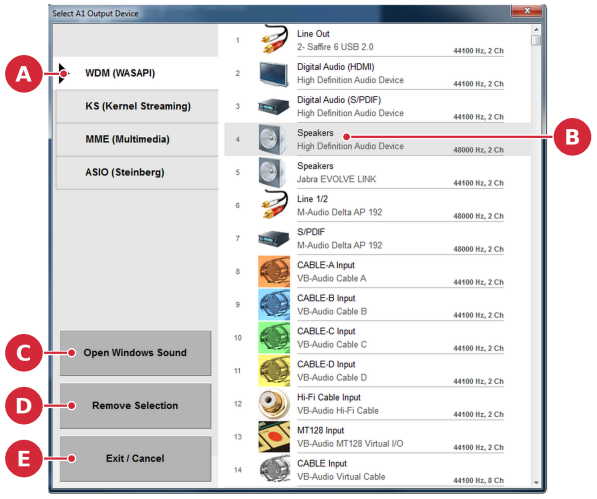
4 Hardware Out A1-A5

Top right. Five buttons - one for each pair of headphones or speakers you can use.



Real screenshot, Potato 3.1.3.0 on Windows 10 - nothing picked on A1 yet.

#	Control	What it does
1	**A1**	Click to pick your main headphones or speakers. A1 is the boss: it sets the clock and sample rate for the whole mixer. Set it first.
2 to 5	A2, A3, A4, A5	Extra real outputs: a second headset, room speakers and so on.
6	48kHz	The sample rate the whole mixer runs at. A1 sets it.
7	512	Not labelled in the manual. Most likely the buffer size: 512 samples is the WDM default. Leave it.
8	Internal Master CLOCK	Nothing on A1 yet: Potato runs on its own clock. Pick A1 and it sets the clock.
9	11 ms	Not explained in the manual. Leave it.



What opens when you click A1 (official manual figure, p.14).

A	WDM / KS / MME / ASIO	Driver type. Pick **ASIO** (if you have one) or **WDM**. MME only if WDM does not work.
B	Device list	Click your headphones or speakers.
C to E	Buttons	**Open Windows Sound** opens the Windows Sound box. **Remove Selection** un-picks the device. **Exit / Cancel** closes the list.

Hardware Out in real life

Zoom / Teams training room

A1 = trainer's headset. **A2** = the room speakers. Turn **A2** ON only on the strips the room should hear - a training video, say.

Podcast recording

A1 = host's headphones, **A2** = guest's headphones. Host mic strip: **A2** ON, so the guest hears you. Guest mic strip: **A1** ON, so you hear the guest. Nobody hears their own voice back.

Discord gaming

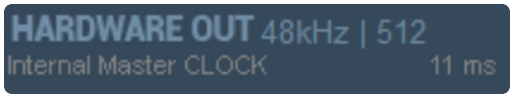
A1 = your headset, **A2** = desk speakers. Game strip: A1 and A2 ON. Discord (AUX) strip: A1 only - the room hears the game, not your friends.

Try it now: Click **A2**. Look at the list and the WDM / KS / MME / ASIO tabs. Do not pick anything - click **Exit / Cancel**.

STOP - another app can't play to your headphones? Potato is holding them: WDM and KS devices are used "exclusive" by default. Send that app's sound through Potato instead.
A small echo when A1 and A2 both play? VB-Audio says outputs are not exactly in sync - that is normal. It can be fixed with a delay in System Settings.

CHECK: You can say what is on your A1 - and you know A1 must be set before anything else works.

The HARDWARE OUT readout, and picking A1



Real screenshot, fresh install - nothing on A1 yet.

Readout	What the manual says
48kHz	The sample rate the whole mixer runs at - A1 sets it. A1 can run at 32, 44.1, 48, 88.2, 96, 176.4 or 192 kHz.
512	**Not labelled in the manual.** Most likely the buffer size in samples: A1 sets the buffer, WDM devices use 512 by default (MME 1024), and the manual's own picture shows 256 here with an ASIO device. Buffering is changed in Menu > System Settings - leave it.
Internal Master CLOCK	No device on A1, so Potato runs on its own clock. Once you pick A1, that device gives the clock (the manual's pictures then show the device name here).
11 ms	**Not explained in the manual.** (Its picture shows 5 ms with an ASIO device.) Leave it.

Pick A1 - in 4 steps (Step 3 of Part 1 shows it in full):

1. 

Click **A1**

2. Pick the tab: **ASIO** if you have one, otherwise **WDM**. MME only if WDM fails.

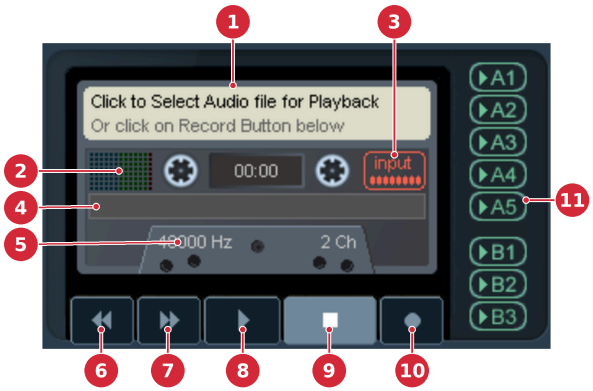
3. Click your headphones or speakers in the list.

4. The header now shows your device instead of "Internal Master CLOCK".

STOP - another app lost its sound when you picked A1? WDM and KS devices are used "exclusive" by default - Potato holds them. Send that app through Potato instead.
Choppy, crackling sound? The buffer may be too small for this PC: ask your trainer (going below 256 samples can be unstable).

5 The cassette recorder

The little tape deck, top right. It plays sound files and records what Potato hears.



Real screenshot, Potato 3.1.3.0 on Windows 10.

#	Control	What it does
1	Cassette top	Click it to choose a file to play. Then it shows the file name and folder.
2	Input level	How loud the sound going to the recorder is.
3	Armed source	What will be recorded - **input** here.
4	Progress bar	Click it to jump to a spot in the file.
5	Sound format	Rate and channels: 48000 Hz, 2 Ch.
6 to 9	REW, FF, Play, Stop	Like a real tape player.
10	Record / Pause	Records to a new file in **Documents > Voicemeeter**, named with the date and time.
11	A1-B3	Where the played file goes - your ears (A), a call (B).

Right-click the tape deck for the Recorder Options - what to record, file type, timer and more. Every option is explained two pages on.

The recorder in real life

Podcast recording

Right-click the tape deck. Choose **Post-fader outputs (B)** and the bus both mics go to - **BUS B1**. Close the box, press **Record (10)**. Press **Stop (9)** at the end.

Zoom / Teams training

Record the session for people who missed it: record **BUS B1** the same way. Set **H** (stop after) to the length of the session, so it stops by itself.

OBS stream / Discord

Play an intro jingle: click the **cassette top (1)**, pick the file, turn **A1** (you) and **B1** (stream or call) ON at **11**, press **Play (8)**.

Try it now: Press **Record (10)**, say "testing, one, two", press **Stop (9)**. Open **Documents > Voicemeeter** - your file is there. Click the cassette top and play it back.

STOP - the recording is silent or wrong? Look at **3**: that is what is being recorded. Right-click the tape deck and pick the right inputs or bus.
A file is stuck and won't let go? Menu > Eject Cassette (release audio file).

CHECK: You made a test recording, found it in Documents > Voicemeeter, and played it back.

Recorder Options in full

Right-click the tape deck to open this box.



Official manual figure (p.45) - this box only opens on right-click.

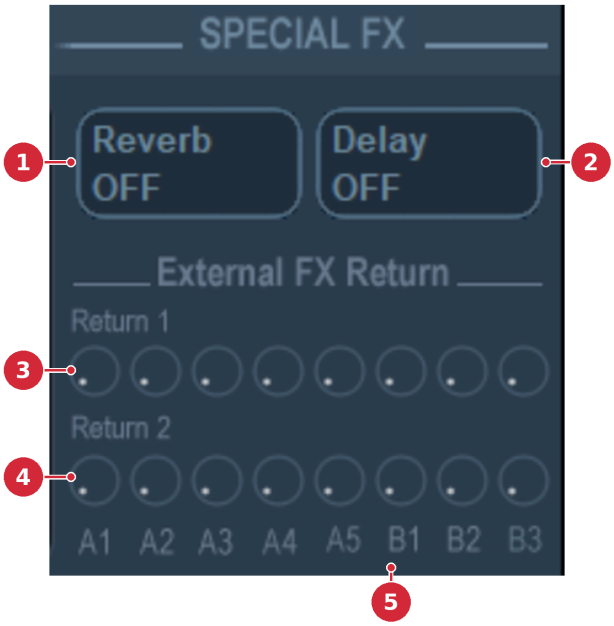
#	Option	What it does
A	Pre-fader inputs	The default. Records one or all inputs mixed in stereo, **before** faders, effects, mute and solo - the raw sound.
B	Post-fader outputs	Records ONE bus - exactly what you hear on it (2 to 8 channels). The bus does not need a device.
C	Folder and file name	Click to change the folder or the name start (default "Record").
D	File type	WAV, BWF, AIFF or MP3 (32-320 kbps; stereo only). Others: up to 8 channels. The file's sample rate can differ from Potato's.
E	Pre-recording buffer	Potato always keeps the last seconds (20 s buffer by default). Set a number of seconds to save them at the start of the file. 0 = off.
F	Play on load / Loop	Start playing as soon as a file is chosen / play it over and over.
G	Playback gain	Volume of the file being played.
H	Stop record after	A timer that stops recording by itself. 00:00:00 = off.
	Multitrack	YES = also one file per channel ("_Track1", "_Track2"...).

Try it now - record what the call hears:

1. Right-click the tape deck. Pick **B** and **BUS B1**. Close.
2.  Click **Record**. Talk.
3.  Click **Stop**.
4. Open **Documents > Voicemeeter**: the file is named with date and time.

6 Special FX: Reverb and Delay

Top right corner. Potato's own echo effects - plus the returns for outside effects.

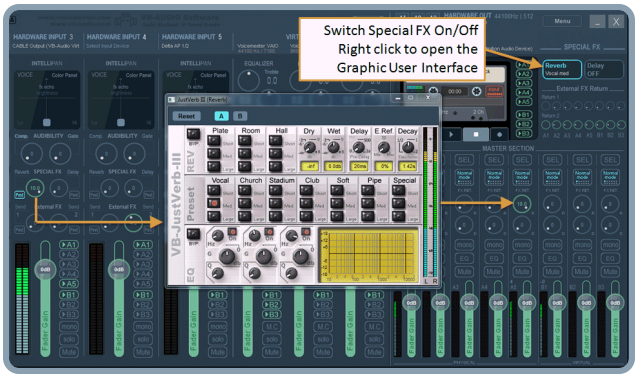


Real screenshot, Potato 3.1.3.0 on Windows 10.

#	Control	What it does
1	**Reverb**	Turns the reverb ("room sound") ON / OFF - it says **OFF** here. Right-click opens its panel.
2	**Delay**	Same for the Delay (repeating echo). Can be swapped for the C5 compressor in System Settings.
3	Return 1	How much of outside effect 1 comes back into each bus.
4	Return 2	The same for outside effect 2.
5	A1 ... B3	Which bus each Return knob feeds.

How effects work - send and return: an effect needs **three** things.
1. The effect button ON (here). 2. A **send** knob turned up on the mic strip (Section 2, numbers 7 and 8). 3. A **return** knob turned up on the output bus (Section 7, numbers 3 and 4).

External FX (3 and 4) only work with an ASIO device on A1, with its channels set in System Settings. Beginners: leave them at 0.



Right-click Reverb to open its panel (official manual figure, p.39). Orange arrows: from a strip's send, to a bus's return.

Special FX in real life

Podcast recording

A touch of "room" on the host's voice: **Reverb ON (1)**, host strip **Reverb send** up a little, **B1 reverb return** up. A little goes a long way.

OBS stream

A big echo for a "hype" moment: **Delay ON (2)**, mic **Delay send** up, stream bus **Delay return** up. Turn the send back to 0 afterwards.

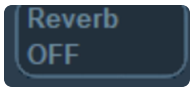
Zoom / Teams training

Keep Reverb and Delay **OFF**. A clear, dry voice is easiest to understand on a call.

Try it now: Click **Reverb (1)** ON. Turn the mic strip's Reverb send up. Turn **A1**'s reverb return up (Section 7, number 3). Talk - you hear the reverb in your headphones. Now set both knobs back to 0.

STOP - effect does nothing? Check all three: button ON, send up, return up. **External FX does nothing?** Normal - it needs an ASIO device on A1. Leave it at 0.

CHECK: You can say the three things an effect needs: button, send, return.



The Reverb panel

Click Reverb = ON / OFF. **Right-click** Reverb = open its panel, **JustVerb III**.



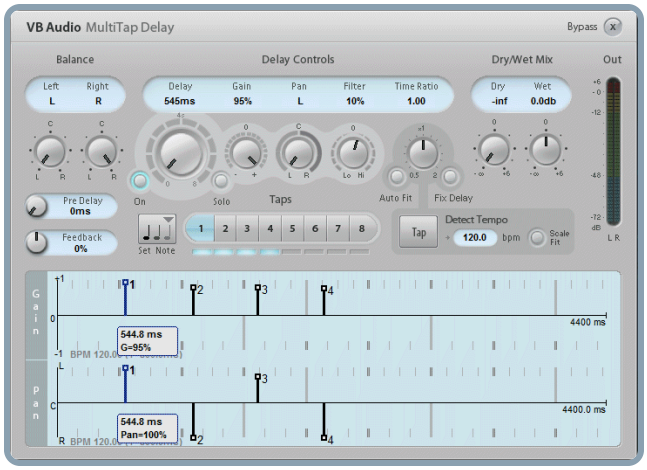
The JustVerb III panel (official manual figure, p.40).

Control	What it does
Presets	10 x 3 ready-made reverbs (Plate, Room, Hall, Vocal, Church...). Pick one, then fine-tune.
DRY	Amount of the original sound. With send / return (the normal way in Potato) keep it at minimum.
WET	Amount of reverb. With send / return usually 0.0 dB.
DELAY	Pre-delay: a gap before the reverb starts, up to 1000 ms.
E.Ref	Early reflections: strengthens the start of the reverb.
DECAY	Reverb length, 50% to 200% of the preset (1 = 100%).
BYP	Bypass: switches off the whole reverb, or just its EQ.
3-band EQ	Changes the colour of the reverb.

Remember: the reverb is heard only if **a send** (Section 2) and **a return** (Section 7, knob R) are both turned up.

Delay OFF The Delay panel (and C5)

Right-click Delay to open the **MultiTap Delay**: up to 8 echoes ("taps") placed on a musical timeline.



The MultiTap Delay panel (official manual figure, p.41).

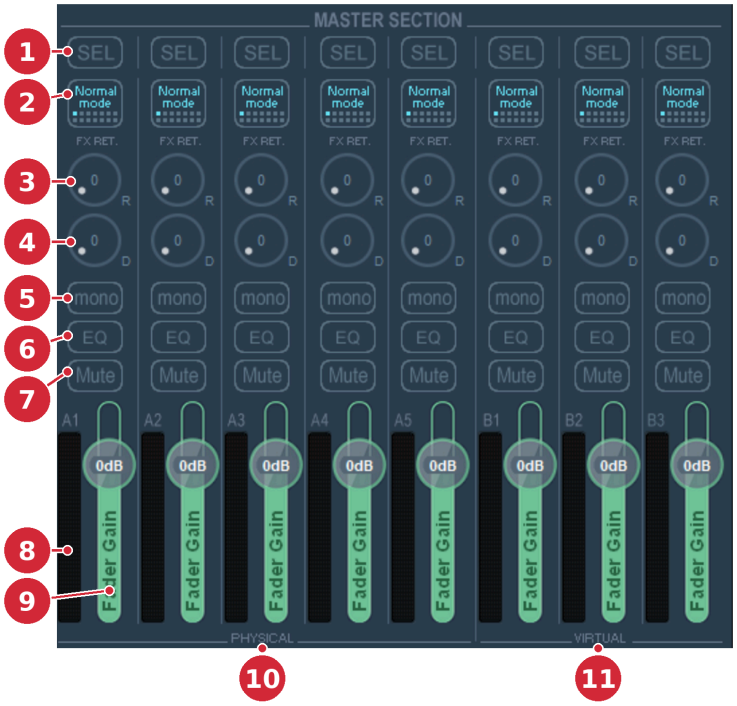
Control	What it does
Taps 1-8	Each echo has its own gain, left / right pan and filter. Place them on the Gain and Pan timelines.
Tempo / Time Ratio	The timeline follows the tempo (bpm). Time Ratio stretches the rhythm to another tempo.
Tap, Scale Fit, Fix Delay, Auto Fit	Tap the **Tap** button in time with the music to set a tempo (shown in red after 4 taps). Scale Fit keeps it, Fix Delay sets all delays to it, Auto Fit does this automatically.
Set Note	Sets a delay time as a note length.
DRY / WET / PRE-DELAY / BYPASS	As on the Reverb (pre-delay up to 1000 ms; bypass = off).
Balance (L / R)	Re-balance the input: mono or reversed stereo.
Feedback	Sends the output back in - more repeats.

C5 instead of Delay

In **Menu > System Settings** the Delay can be swapped for **C5**, a 5-band compressor for hardware inputs. The button and the sends then say **C5** / **C**. Strips sending to C5 should have their A / B buttons OFF on buses that get the C5 return, or the sound doubles. Trainer setting.

7 The Master section: all 8 outputs

Bottom right. One column per output bus: **A1-A5** go to real devices, **B1-B3** to virtual ones. All 8 columns work the same.



Real screenshot, Potato 3.1.3.0 on Windows 10.

#	Control	What it does
1	SEL	Select this bus's own mix: the input faders now show and set levels for this bus only.
2	Bus mode	How the bus's 8 channels are arranged. Keep **Normal mode**.
3	FX RET. R	Reverb return into this bus.
4	FX RET. D	Delay return (shows C when C5 is in use).
5	mono	Stereo to mono. Click twice: swaps left and right.
6	EQ	This bus's 6-band EQ ON / OFF. Right-click to open it.
7	Mute	Mutes this whole output.
8	Meter	How loud this output is. Its name sits on top.
9	Fader Gain	Volume of this whole output.

10	**PHYSICAL** A1-A5	Go to real headphones and speakers (Section 4).
11	**VIRTUAL** B1-B3	Appear in Windows as recording devices: B1 = **Voicemeeter Output**, B2 = **Voicemeeter Aux Output**, B3 = **Voicemeeter VAIO3 Output**. Newer names: **Voicemeeter Out B1 / B2 / B3**.

The Master section in real life

Zoom / Teams training

Need a private word? Click **Mute (7)** on **B1** - the call hears nothing from you. Click again to come back. Everything is too loud in your headset? Lower the **A1 fader (9)**.

OBS stream + Discord together

Discord's mic = **Voicemeeter Output** (B1). OBS's audio = **Voicemeeter Aux Output** (B2). Now the stream and your friends can get different mixes - use **SEL (1)** to set each one.

Podcast recording

Record **BUS B1** with the cassette (Section 5) and watch the **B1 meter (8)** move while you both talk. Still? Nothing is reaching B1 - check B1 is ON on both mic strips.

Try it now: Play a video. Drag the **A1 fader (9)** down, then back up. Click **A1 Mute (7)** - silence. Click it again - sound is back.

STOP - all the input faders suddenly show strange numbers? You clicked a **SEL** button: the faders now show that bus's own mix. Click the lit SEL again to go back.
Bus mode no longer says "Normal mode"? Ask your trainer - the manual does not say how to change it back.

CHECK: You can point at A1 and B1 in the Master section, and say which one is your ears and which one is the call.

The 14 bus modes

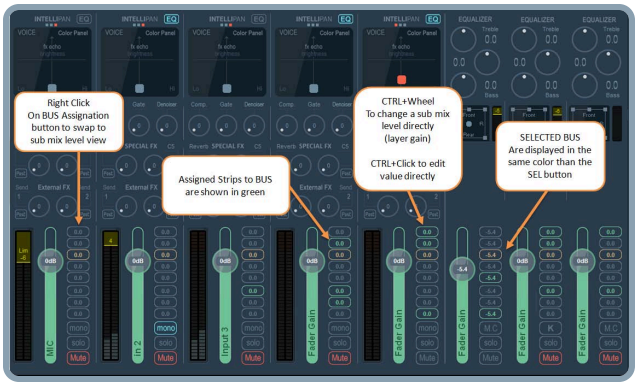
Each bus has 8 channels. The **mode** button sets how they are arranged. **Keep Normal mode** for headphones, speakers, calls and streams.

Mode	What it does (plain words)
Normal	All channels sent as they are. **Use this.**
Mix Down A / B	Folds 5.1 / 7.1 sound (e.g. a DVD on a virtual input) into 2 speakers. A = rear mixed out of phase (fake surround); B = in phase.
Stereo Repeat	Stereo copied to channels 3+4, 5+6, 7+8 - with the bus EQ it can split sound for 2- to 4-way active speakers.
Composite	The 8 channels are built from chosen inputs (set in System Settings) - for recording up to 8 separate tracks.
Up Mix TV / 2.1 / 4.1 / 6.1	Spreads stereo out to more speakers (TV-style 7.1, or with sub, rear and side speakers).
Left / Right / Center / LFE / Rear Only	Pulls out one part: left, right, centre, the sub-woofer (LFE), or the rear pair - e.g. for a sub-woofer or a rear Bluetooth speaker.

The manual lists the 14 modes with formulas (p.38) but does not say how to step through them on the button. If a bus no longer says "Normal mode", ask your trainer.

SEL - mix per bus

Click SEL on a bus: the input faders now show and set the levels for **that bus only**. **CTRL + click** selects several buses. In the bus-mix view, **CTRL + mouse wheel** changes a value and **CTRL + click** lets you type it.



Right-click any strip A / B button: all mixes at once (official manual figure, p.32).

Bus EQ, return knobs, limiter and names



Real screenshots, bus A1.

Control	What it does - and the tricks
FX RET. R	How much Reverb comes back into this bus.
FX RET. D	How much Delay comes back (shows C when C5 is used).
mono	Stereo to mono. **Click twice** = swaps left and right.
EQ	**Click** = this bus's 6-band EQ ON / OFF. **Right-click** = open it.
EQ colours	Per channel: **green** = equalized or gain changed, **red** = delayed, **yellow** = both, **black** = nothing.
Mute	Mutes this whole output.
Meter + fader	Level and volume of the output. Click in the meter to set a limit: -20 to 0 dB (as on the strips). The output limiter is ON by default.
Bus name	Right-click the bottom of the bus fader to name it (e.g. "Zoom").



The bus EQ window (official manual figure, p.33).

In the EQ window: 6 cells for each of the 8 channels (or all at once); **FLAT** = reset; **A / B** = two memories to compare; **CH COPY** / **COPY ALL** = copy settings; **right-click** Gain / Q / Frequency to type a value; the icon at top left can **Load / Save** the EQ.

Mouse and keyboard tricks

Every trick the manual documents, in one place.

Do this	On	What happens
Double-click	Any knob, fader or pan	Back to its default value (pan: Normal mode, centre).
Right-click	INTELLIPAN panel	Switch Color / Position 3D / Modulation.
Right-click	Word INTELLIPAN	Strip Menu: reset, copy / paste, save / load.
Click	Word EQUALIZER (virtual)	Strip Menu of a virtual strip.
Right-click	Small EQ button (hardware)	6-band EQ window.
Right-click (again)	Comp. / Gate / Denoiser	Detailed view (and back).
CTRL + right-click	Setting in a detail view / the knob	Type a value / undo.
SHIFT + click	Setting in a detail view	Precision slider.
Click / right-click	Inside a meter	Set a limit / type it.
CTRL + click	Strip meter	Yellow / green limiter.
Right-click	Bottom of a fader	Give the strip or bus a name.
Right-click	A strip's A / B buttons	See all bus mixes (and back).
CTRL + wheel / CTRL + click	A sub-mix value	Change it / type it.
CTRL + click	SEL	Select several buses.
Click twice	Bus mono	Swap left and right.
Right-click	Pan box (virtual)	Pan-mode menu.
Right-click	Virtual strip name	Delay (latency) menu.
Right-click	App list	Show up to 32 apps.
Right-click	Tape deck	Recorder Options.
Click / right-click	Reverb or Delay	ON / OFF / open panel.
Click / right-click	Bus EQ	ON / OFF / open EQ window.
Click / right-click	Audio Map icon	Audio Map / Windows sound boxes.
Click	Strip name area	Pick the input device.

Keyboard shortcuts (shown in the Menu)

CTRL+R Restart Audio Engine
CTRL+1 VBAN Options
CTRL+2 VBAN Chat Room
CTRL+3 M.I.D.I. Mapping
CTRL+4 Preset Scene
CTRL+5 Tape Recorder Options
CTRL+6 Windows Audio Map
CTRL+, System Settings

In the Preset Scene box: **ENTER** or **CTRL**+click recalls a preset; **F1**-**F24** recall the first 24.

WHEN SOMETHING GOES WRONG

No sound? Check in THIS order

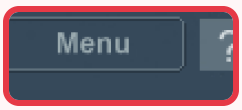
Do not jump around. Start at 1. Most problems die at 1, 2 or 3.

1 Is Potato actually open?
No Potato open = no sound at all. Open it from the Start menu and leave it open.

2 Is A1 picked, top-right?
A1 must show your headphones or speakers (Step 3).

3 Is A1 lit up on the strip that is playing?
Dark A1 button = that sound goes nowhere you can hear (Step 6).

4 Still stuck? Restart the engine, not the computer
In Potato, click this real **Menu** button in the top-right corner:



Then choose **Restart Audio Engine**. Then restart the app with no sound (Discord, OBS) - not the whole PC.

Hearing your own voice in your headphones? That is mic A1 switched ON by mistake. Turn mic A1 OFF, keep mic B1 ON (Step 6).

CHECK: Sound is back. Write down which number fixed it - that is your number next time too.

CUT OUT AND KEEP BY THE COMPUTER

Quick reference card

If you want...	Do this
Hear anything at all	Potato open + **A1** = your headphones (Step 3)
Be heard on a call	Mic = Input 1, **B1 ON, A1 OFF** (Steps 4 + 6)
Hear a video / game	VAIO strip, **A1 ON** (Step 6)
Share video sound on a call	VAIO strip, add **B1 ON** (Step 6)
Windows default	Playback: **Voicemeeter Input (VAIO)** Recording: **Voicemeeter Output (VAIO)**
App mic (Discord/Zoom/OBS)	**Voicemeeter Output** = microphone **Voicemeeter Aux Input** = speaker
Can't see Voicemeeter Output?	Look for **Voicemeeter Out B1** - same thing, newer name
No sound	Potato open? A1 picked? A1 lit? Restart Audio Engine

A

A = Actual ears - for you

B

B = Broadcast - for them

Version 3 - checked against the official manual. This SOP has been error-checked against the official VoiceMeeter Potato User Manual (Voicemeeter 3.1.3.0, VB-Audio Software, vb-audio.com; ZIP package Voicemeeter8Setup_v3130.zip, 72.2 MB; install as administrator and reboot). Four fixes came from that check: (1) the newer name **Voicemeeter Out B1** means the same as Voicemeeter Output; (2) Step 3 now adds **Run on Windows Startup**, so Potato opens by itself after every restart; (3) Step 5 now sets the **Communications** tab to **Do nothing**, so calls do not turn your sound down; (4) Step 3 now mentions **ASIO** as well as WDM for A1. Button pictures in this version: the A1 to A5 buttons, the strip A1 and B1 buttons, the Menu button, and the Windows Sound box with its Set Default and OK buttons are tight crops cut out of real screenshots, so they match what you see on screen. The download and install pictures (Steps 1 and 2) are still labelled diagrams, and a live run-through on a real Windows PC is still to come. **Part 2** pictures are real Windows 10 screenshots of Potato 3.1.3.0; boxes and menus that only open on a click are labelled VB-Audio manual figures.

You did it. Potato is installed, Windows obeys it, your voice goes to B1 and your ears live on A1. That is a working setup.